

Email and Outlook Troubleshooting Guide

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1. Scope

This guide covers the mail client: sign-in prompts that will not clear, mail that does not send or receive, calendar and free-busy problems, shared mailboxes, and mailbox storage limits.

2. Repeated Sign-In Prompts

A mail client that prompts for a password repeatedly is nearly always holding a cached credential that no longer matches the account, most often after a recent password change. Close the client completely, remove the stored credential from the operating system credential store, then reopen the client and sign in once.

If the prompt returns immediately after a correct password is entered, check whether the account is locked, as described in the Password Reset and Account Access Guide. A remote worker should confirm the VPN is connected before troubleshooting further.

3. Mail Not Sending or Receiving

- Check the connection status in the client; a client in offline or disconnected mode queues mail without warning.
- Check the outbox for a large attachment blocking the queue. The attachment limit is 25 MB per message; use the approved file sharing service for anything larger.
- Check the junk and quarantine folders for missing incoming mail before reporting it as lost.
- Confirm the message was not blocked by a mail rule created earlier and forgotten.
- Test the same mailbox in a browser. If mail flows in the browser but not in the desktop client, the fault is with the local profile rather than the mailbox.

4. Calendar and Free-Busy Problems

Free-busy information that shows as unavailable for a colleague usually indicates a permission or synchronisation delay rather than a fault. Wait for one synchronisation cycle and check again in a browser before raising a ticket.

Meeting invitations that arrive without the calendar action buttons have normally been forwarded rather than sent directly. Ask the organiser to reissue the invitation to the mailbox rather than forwarding it.

5. Shared Mailboxes and Delegation

Access to a shared mailbox is requested as an IT ticket with the request type Software Issue, naming the mail client in the software name field and the shared mailbox address in the description. The mailbox owner must confirm the request before access is granted. Permission changes take up to one hour to appear in the desktop client and are visible sooner in the browser.

6. Mailbox Storage Limits

The standard mailbox quota is 50 GB. A warning is sent at 45 GB and sending is blocked at the quota. Clearing the deleted items folder and removing large attachments is usually enough to recover space. Quota increases are approved only where an operational need is demonstrated and an archive policy has been applied first.